CS-02_Employee_Script

System	Employee communications (phone, email, in-person) + HR intake workflow
Owner	HR Department (HR Administrative Assistant executes; HR Manager investigates)
When	Anytime an employee asks a question, raises a concern, or submits a complaint
Output	Employee receives clear, professional guidance; issues are documented; escalations routed correctly

Key Points:

- Employees appreciate transparency and being direct. They understand that sometimes the answer will be “no,” or that a complaint may not be solved immediately.
- Stay professional. Sound confident. Be honest and transparent.
- Use the correct channel: email for clear documentation; phone/in-person for nuance and de-escalation when needed.
- In person: practice active listening, use clarifying and open-ended questions, and maintain appropriate eye contact.
- Complaints must be documented on the complaint form and include the employee’s statement. After paperwork is completed, turn it over to the HR Manager with a brief synopsis so an investigation can be opened.
- Pay questions are routed to the HR Manager.
- Safety concerns require detailed documentation (what/when/where/why/how). If it’s not documented, it’s like it never happened.
- Points questions require verification through BambooHR, the Point Notebook, or the Point Website—any is acceptable. Provide accurate totals, roll-offs, perfect attendance bonuses, and current point balance.

Steps

Step	Action
1	Identify the topic (pay, points, PTO, performance, safety, complaint, or general policy question).
2	Choose the right channel (email/phone/in-person). Use the scripts below as baseline language.
3	For phone/in-person: use active listening and clarifying/open-ended questions before offering solutions.
4	Provide direct, transparent information within your role. Do not guess or promise outcomes.
5	If it is a complaint: complete the complaint form and obtain the employee’s statement in their own words.
6	After complaint paperwork is completed: provide a short synopsis and turn over the packet to the HR Manager so an investigation can be opened.
7	Document the interaction (date/time, method, what was asked, what was said, and any follow-up or escalation).
8	Follow up by the committed date. If timelines change, update the employee promptly.

Scripts

How to respond to an employee concern (Email)

Subject: Re: Your Concern

Hello [Employee Name]!

Thank you for reaching out. I understand your concern about [briefly restate issue].

I want to be transparent with you: [state what you know / what you can and cannot do right now].

Here's what I can do next: [next step within your role]. If this requires review by the HR Manager, I will route it promptly.

I will follow up with you by [Date].

Thanks!

[Your Signature]

Notes:

- Be direct and professional. Avoid blame or speculation.
- If the answer is "no," state it respectfully and explain the policy/process briefly.

How to respond to an employee concern (In Person / Phone)

Active listening opener: "Thanks for bringing this to me. I want to make sure I understand."

Clarify: "Can you walk me through what happened from start to finish?"

Confirm: "So what I'm hearing is [restate in one sentence]. Did I get that right?"

Transparent response: "Here's what I can tell you right now…"

Next steps: "Here's what will happen next, and when you can expect an update."

Notes:

- Maintain eye contact and a neutral expression; do not interrupt.
- Use open-ended questions (what/when/where/how) and then ask specifics.

If you don't know the answer (commit to follow-up) (Email)

Subject: Re: Your Question

Hello [Employee Name]!

I want to make sure that I provide accurate information. Let me do some investigating and I'll follow up with you by [Date].

Thanks!

[Your Signature]

Notes:

- Do not guess. Verify with policy, system records, or the HR Manager.

If an employee has a complaint (intake + documentation) (In Person / Phone)

"Thank you for bringing this forward. I'm going to document what you're reporting so it can be reviewed appropriately."

"I'm going to ask a few questions so we capture the details accurately: what happened, when and where it happened, who was involved, and whether there were witnesses."

"I'll also need your statement in your own words for the complaint form."

"Once the paperwork is completed, I will turn it over to the HR Manager and provide a synopsis so the HR Manager can open an investigation."

Notes:

- Complete the complaint form and obtain the employee statement.
- Do not promise outcomes; promise process and follow-up only.

If an employee has a complaint (intake + documentation) (Email)

Subject: Re: Your Complaint

Hello [Employee Name]!

Thank you for letting us know about your concern. I want to be transparent about the next steps: we will document your complaint and your statement, and then I will route it to the HR Manager with a synopsis so an investigation can be opened.

To make sure we capture details accurately, please reply with: what happened, when and where it occurred, who was involved, and whether there were witnesses.

Thanks!

[Your Signature]

If an employee has a question about their pay (route to HR Manager) (Email)

Subject: Re: Pay Question

Hello [Employee Name]!

Pay questions need to be reviewed directly by the HR Manager to ensure accuracy. I'm forwarding your question to the HR Manager now.

To help with review, please include the pay period date and whether this relates to hours, overtime, bonus, or a deduction.

Thanks!

[Your Signature]

If an employee has a question about their pay (route to HR Manager) (In Person / Phone)

"Pay questions need to be reviewed by the HR Manager to ensure accuracy. I can help gather details so the HR Manager can review quickly."

"Which pay period is this for, and what part looks incorrect—hours, overtime, bonus, or a deduction?"

"I'll share this with the HR Manager today and you'll receive follow-up."

If an employee has a safety concern (document everything) (In Person / Phone)

"Thanks for reporting this. I'm going to document everything so it can be addressed."

"Please tell me: what happened, when it happened, where it happened, why you think it happened, and how it occurred."

"Were there witnesses? Has anyone been injured? Is there an immediate hazard right now?"

"I'm going to escalate this to the HR Manager/Safety lead with your details."

Notes:

- Document what/when/where/why/how and witnesses.
- If it's an immediate hazard or injury, follow emergency procedures first.
- Remember: if it's not documented, it's like it never happened.

If an employee has a question about their points (verify + explain) (Email)

Subject: Re: Attendance Points

Hello [Employee Name]!

I can help with that. I'm going to review your points using BambooHR, the Point Notebook, or the Point Website and confirm your current point total, any roll-offs, and any perfect attendance bonuses.

If you have a specific date you're asking about, please include it so I can verify faster.

Thanks!

[Your Signature]

Provide verified points information (after lookup) (Email)

Subject: Re: Attendance Points (Verified)

Hello [Employee Name]!

Here's what I found after reviewing your points:

• Current point total: [#]

• Points added (date/reason): [list briefly]

• Roll-off date(s): [date(s)]

• Perfect attendance bonus(es): [details if applicable]

If you want me to verify any specific date(s) again, let me know which date(s).

Thanks!

[Your Signature]

Notes:

- Keep details factual and brief. Do not debate the policy in email—route disputes to HR Manager.

If an employee wants a point excused (no-fault reminder + PTO option) (In Person / Phone)

“API/AAP uses a no-fault point system for cases just like this. We understand that life happens and things can come up at the last minute.”

“Our PTO policy is meant to help you cover pre-planned events or appointments. Did you want to see if you have any PTO you can use instead of taking the point?”

“Reminder: vacation must be taken in 2-hour increments and personal time must be taken in 1-hour increments.”

If an employee has a performance/performance review question (Email)

Subject: Re: Performance Review Question

Hello [Employee Name]!

Performance is based on multiple metrics (12 total), including attendance, teamwork, and initiative.

If you feel your performance was graded unfairly, you may file a complaint with the HR Manager to start an investigation.

If the HR Manager is not available right now, I can provide her contact information, and I will send a summary of your concern to the HR Manager.

Thanks!

[Your Signature]

If an employee has a PTO question (review balances + explain accrual rules) (Email)

Subject: Re: PTO Question

Hello [Employee Name]!

I can see why you’re confused, but I can help. I’m going to review your PTO balances in BambooHR and look for any discrepancies.

A few important items to remember:

• PTO cannot be taken before it is earned/accrued.

• Personal time for full-time employees is an annual drop on the anniversary of the FULL-TIME hire date (not necessarily the original hire date).

• If someone was hired part-time and later became full-time, the accrual date is based on the date they began full-time employment.

• Part-time employees earn 1 hour of personal time for every 30 hours worked (updated on Monday of the following week).

I can see why you're confused, but I can help. PTO accrual is based on the full-time hire date, not necessarily the day you started with API/AAP.

Thanks!

[Your Signature]

If an employee asks for a policy exception (In Person / Phone)

“I understand why you’re asking, and I want to be transparent: I can’t approve exceptions to policy in this role.”

“What I can do is document your request and route it to the HR Manager for review.”

“To submit it accurately, I’ll need: [brief details].”

If an employee is upset or angry (de-escalation + boundaries) (In Person / Phone)

“I can hear that this is frustrating. I want to help.”

“I’m going to ask a couple questions so I understand clearly.”

“I can continue this conversation as long as we keep it respectful.”

“Here’s what I can do right now, and here’s what needs HR Manager review.”

If an employee asks for confidentiality (set accurate expectations) (Email)

Subject: Re: Your Concern

Hello [Employee Name]!

Thank you for sharing this. I will handle this professionally and only share details with those who need to know in order to address it.

I also want to be transparent: I can’t promise absolute confidentiality if the information needs to be reviewed by the HR Manager or if it involves safety or policy compliance.

Thanks!

[Your Signature]

If an employee reports harassment/discrimination/retaliation (immediate escalation) (In Person / Phone)

“Thank you for telling me. I’m going to document what you reported and route this to the HR Manager immediately so it can be reviewed.”

“I’m going to ask a few questions for the record: what happened, when and where, who was involved, and any witnesses.”

“If you have any texts, emails, or screenshots, please keep them—they may be important for the review.”

Notes:

- Do not investigate yourself. Intake + documentation + immediate handoff to HR Manager.

Checks:

Communication is professional and direct; email format uses “Hello [Employee Name]!” and closes with “Thanks!” and signature; the correct escalation path is used; documentation is complete; and follow-up is completed by the promised date.

Escalate to HR Manager immediately if:

The issue involves pay accuracy, safety hazards, threats/violence, harassment/discrimination/retaliation, suspected fraud, policy exceptions, or any complaint requiring investigation. Escalate if facts are disputed or if the employee requests formal review.

HR Incident/Complaint Report Form

Internal Reporting Incident Form for Workplace Incidents.

Full Name: Today's Date:

Job Title: Department:

Supervisor's Name:

Phone Number: Email:

SECTION 1: INCIDENT DETAILS

Please check that box that best describes the nature of your incident.

☐ Harassment ☐ Discrimination ☐ Retaliation ☐ Safety Violation

☐ Ethics/Policy Violation ☐ Other: _____

Date of Incident: Time of Incident:

Location of Incident:

Name of Individual(s) Involved:

Full Name	Title

HR Incident/Complaint Report Form

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SECTION 2: DESCRIPTION OF INCIDENT

Please provide a detailed account of what occurred. Please include any specific statements, conduct, or actions that were inappropriate or a violation of company policy.

HR Incident/Complaint Report Form

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SECTION 3: WITNESSES

Please provide the names of individuals who may have witnessed the incident.

Full Name	Title

☐ Check this box if there are no witnesses to report

SECTION 4: PREVIOUS ACTIONS TAKEN (IF ANY)

Please let us know if you have reported this previously.

☐ No. This is my first time reporting this incident.

☐ Yes. I have previously reported this incident to:

Full Name: _____ Date Reported: _____

What Happened: _____

SECTION 5: DESIRED OUTCOME/RESOLUTION

Please let us know the desired outcome you would like to see happen as a result of this report.

☐ **Mediation** ☐ **Investigation** ☐ **Training** ☐ **Disciplinary Action**

☐ **Other:** _____

HR Incident Report Form

Internal Reporting Incident Form for Workplace Incidents.

CONFIDENTIALITY AGREEMENT

This Confidentiality Agreement ("Agreement") is made to ensure the privacy and integrity of the information shared as part of an employee complaint or workplace incident report.

Purpose

The purpose of this agreement is to acknowledge the sensitive nature of the information disclosed and to establish expectations around confidentiality for all parties involved.

Confidential Handling

The Human Resources department will handle this matter with the highest level of confidentiality possible. Information shared in this report may be disclosed only on a need-to-know basis to:

- Investigate the incident appropriately,
- Comply with legal or regulatory obligations,
- Protect the safety and rights of employees and the organization.

Employee Acknowledgement

By signing below, I acknowledge that:

- I am submitting this complaint/report in good faith and to the best of my knowledge.
- I understand the information I provide will be used to investigate the concern.
- I agree to maintain the confidentiality of this process to avoid retaliation, speculation, or disruption.
- I understand retaliation for filing a complaint or participating in an investigation is strictly prohibited and should be reported immediately.

No Guarantee of Complete Anonymity

While every effort will be made to protect the identity of individuals involved, complete anonymity cannot be guaranteed during an investigation, especially if specific facts or context make identification unavoidable.

Employee Signature: _____

Printed Name: _____

Date: _____

HR Incident/Complaint Report Form

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